



PASSIVE VOICE OF CAUSATIVE VERBS

MAKE

GET

HAVE

LET

HELP

SSC CGL English Grammar

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What You Will Learn Today

- 1 What causative verbs are and why SSC CGL tests them
- 2 Active structures of MAKE, GET, HAVE, LET and HELP
- 3 The passive rules, including the famous hidden **TO**
- 4 A 10 question MCQ test to lock in your learning

What Are Causative Verbs?

A causative verb shows that the subject **does not do the action himself**. He **causes another person** to do it.

Example:

I cut my hair. (I did it myself)

I had my hair cut. (the barber did it, I caused it)

The second sentence uses the causative verb **HAD**.

The Five Causative Verbs

MAKE

To force or compel someone

GET

To persuade or arrange

HAVE

To assign or arrange a service

LET

To permit or allow

HELP

To assist someone in doing

Why SSC CGL Loves This Topic

- Active Passive conversion questions appear in every SSC CGL Tier 1 and Tier 2 paper
- Causative verbs are the favourite trap because the normal passive rule changes here
- One small word, **TO**, decides whether your answer is right or wrong
- Error spotting questions also test these structures directly

Active Structure: MAKE

MAKE

Subject + make + person + V1 (base form, no TO)

The teacher **made** the students **write** an essay.

The officer **made** him **sign** the papers.

Note: In the active voice, MAKE **never takes TO** before the verb.

Active Structure: GET

GET

Subject + get + person + TO + V1

She **got** her brother **to repair** the laptop.

I **got** the plumber **to fix** the tap.

Note: GET is the **only** causative verb that **always takes TO** in the active voice.

Active Structure: HAVE

HAVE

Subject + have + person + **V1 (base form, no TO)**

I **had** the tailor **stitch** my suit.

We **had** the painter **paint** the walls.

Note: HAVE works like MAKE in the active voice. **No TO** before the verb.

Active Structures: LET and HELP

LET

Subject + let + person + V1 (no TO)

My father **let** me **drive** the new car.

HELP

Subject + help + person + V1 or TO + V1 (both correct)

The coach **helped** the players **improve** their game.

RULE 1

MAKE in the Passive

The hidden TO appears. This is the most tested rule in SSC CGL.

Rule 1: MAKE Brings Back the TO

Active: Subject + make + person + V1

Passive: Person + is/am/are/was/were + made + TO + V1

THE GOLDEN RULE

TO is invisible in the active voice, but it **must appear** in the passive voice. Missing this TO is the number one mistake in the exam.

Rule 1: MAKE Examples

Active: The teacher **made** the students **write** an essay.



Passive: The students **were made to write** an essay by the teacher.

Active: The officer **made** him **sign** the papers.



Passive: He **was made to sign** the papers by the officer.

Watch the TO appear in every passive sentence. **No TO means no marks.**

Rule 1: More MAKE Examples

Active: The principal **makes** us **wear** uniforms.



Passive: We **are made to wear** uniforms by the principal.

Active: They **will make** her **repeat** the test.



Passive: She **will be made to repeat** the test by them.

The rule works in every tense: **is made to, was made to, will be made to.**

RULE 2

LET in the Passive

LET has no natural passive. We replace it with **WAS ALLOWED TO**.

Rule 2: LET Becomes ALLOWED TO

Active: Subject + let + person + V1

Passive: Person + is/was/were + **allowed to** + V1

REMEMBER

Never write **was let to**. LET quietly steps aside and **ALLOWED TO** takes its place.

Rule 2: LET Examples

Active: My father **let** me **drive** the new car.



Passive: I **was allowed to drive** the new car by my father.

Active: The warden **lets** the students **play** till six.



Passive: The students **are allowed to play** till six by the warden.

LET disappears completely in the passive. ALLOWED TO replaces it in the matching tense.

RULE 3

HELP in the Passive

HELP follows MAKE. The TO appears in the passive.

Rule 3: HELP Examples

Active: The coach **helped** the players **improve** their fitness.



Passive: The players **were helped to improve** their fitness by the coach.

Active: The NGO **helps** poor children **get** an education.



Passive: Poor children **are helped to get** an education by the NGO.

Formula: Person + ~~is/was/were~~ + helped + **TO** + **V1**. Same pattern as MAKE.

RULE 4

HAVE and GET

The causative passive: have or get + thing + V3. The service structure.

Rule 4: The Service Structure

Focus on the person: have/get + person + (to) V1

Focus on the thing: have/get + thing + V3 (past participle)

THE KEY IDEA

When the doer is removed and the **thing** becomes the object, the verb changes from V1 to **V3**. This is the causative passive.

Rule 4: HAVE Examples

Active: I **had** the tailor **stitch** my suit.



Passive: I **had** my suit **stitched** by the tailor.

Active: We **had** the painter **paint** the walls.



Passive: We **had** the walls **painted** by the painter.

Person + V1 becomes Thing + V3. The subject and HAVE stay exactly where they are.

Rule 4: GET Examples

Active: She **got** her brother **to repair** the laptop.



Passive: She **got** the laptop **repaired** by her brother.

Active: I **got** the plumber **to fix** the tap.



Passive: I **got** the tap **fixed** by the plumber.

Notice: TO + V1 in the active becomes plain V3 in the causative passive.

Common SSC CGL Traps

Trap 1: She was made **sign** the papers. Correct: was made **to sign**.

Trap 2: I **was let to** go early. Correct: I **was allowed to** go early.

Trap 3: I had my hair **cutted**. Correct: I had my hair **cut** (V3 of cut is cut).

Trap 4: He got the wall **to paint**. Correct: He got the wall **painted**.

Master Summary: All Five Verbs

Verb	Active Structure	Passive Structure
MAKE	make + person + V1	was/were made TO + V1
LET	let + person + V1	was/were allowed TO + V1
HELP	help + person + (to) V1	was/were helped TO + V1
HAVE	have + person + V1	have + thing + V3 (No Be + Past Participle)
GET	get + person + TO + V1	get + thing + V3 (No Be + Past Participle)

MCQ PRACTICE TEST

10 Questions | SSC CGL Pattern | Causative Verbs in Passive Voice

Answer before the reveal!

Question 1 of 10

Choose the correct passive: The teacher made the students clean the classroom.

- A The students were made clean the classroom.
- B The students were made to clean the classroom.
- C The students made to clean the classroom.
- D The students were being made clean the classroom.

Answer: Question 1

Choose the correct passive: The teacher made the students clean the classroom.

- A The students were made clean the classroom.
- B The students were made to clean the classroom. ✓**
- C The students made to clean the classroom.
- D The students were being made clean the classroom.

Why: MAKE in the passive always brings back the hidden TO: were made TO clean.

Question 2 of 10

Choose the correct passive: **She got her brother to repair the laptop.**

A She got the laptop repaired by her brother.

B She got the laptop to repair by her brother.

C The laptop got repaired her brother.

D She was got the laptop repaired.

Answer: Question 2

Choose the correct passive: She got her brother to repair the laptop.

A She got the laptop repaired by her brother. ✓

B She got the laptop to repair by her brother.

C The laptop got repaired her brother.

D She was got the laptop repaired.

Why: GET causative passive: get + thing + V3. TO + V1 changes to V3 (repaired).

Question 3 of 10

Choose the correct passive: **My father let me drive the new car.**

- A I was let to drive the new car.
- B I was allowed to drive the new car.
- C I was let drive the new car.
- D I allowed to drive the new car.

Answer: Question 3

Choose the correct passive: **My father let me drive the new car.**

- A I was let to drive the new car.
- B I was allowed to drive the new car. ✓**
- C I was let drive the new car.
- D I allowed to drive the new car.

Why: LET has no natural passive. It is replaced by WAS ALLOWED TO + V1

Question 4 of 10

Choose the correct causative passive: **I had the tailor stitch my suit.**

- A I had my suit stitch by the tailor.
- B I had my suit stitched by the tailor.
- C I had my suit to stitch by the tailor.
- D My suit had stitched by the tailor.

Answer: Question 4

Choose the correct causative passive: I had the tailor stitch my suit.

- A I had my suit stitch by the tailor.
- B I had my suit stitched by the tailor. ✓**
- C I had my suit to stitch by the tailor.
- D My suit had stitched by the tailor.

Why: HAVE + thing + V3. The verb changes from V1 (stitch) to V3 (stitched).

Question 5 of 10

Choose the correct passive: **The coach helped the players improve their fitness.**

- A** The players were helped improve their fitness.
- B** The players were helped to improve their fitness.
- C** The players helped to improve their fitness.
- D** The players were help to improve their fitness.

Answer: Question 5

Choose the correct passive: **The coach helped the players improve their fitness.**

- A The players were helped improve their fitness.
- B The players were helped to improve their fitness. ✓**
- C The players helped to improve their fitness.
- D The players were help to improve their fitness.

Why: HELP follows the MAKE pattern in the passive: were helped TO + V1

Question 6 of 10

Fill in the blank: The manager _____ the report typed before the meeting.

A made

B got

C let

D helped

Answer: Question 6

Fill in the blank: **The manager _____ the report typed before the meeting.**

A made

B got ✓

C let

D helped

Why: Only GET (or HAVE) fits the structure verb + thing + V3: got the report typed.

Question 7 of 10

Choose the correct passive: The principal makes the latecomers stand outside.

- A The latecomers are made stand outside.
- B The latecomers are made to stand outside.
- C The latecomers are making to stand outside.
- D The latecomers were made to stand outside.

Answer: Question 7

Choose the correct passive: The principal makes the latecomers stand outside.

- A The latecomers are made stand outside.
- B The latecomers are made to stand outside. ✓**
- C The latecomers are making to stand outside.
- D The latecomers were made to stand outside.

Why: Present tense MAKES becomes ARE MADE TO. Option D wrongly changes the tense.

Question 8 of 10

Identify the structure: We got the walls painted last week.

A get + person + to + V1

B get + thing + V3

C get + thing + V1

D get + person + V3

Answer: Question 8

Identify the structure: We got the walls painted last week.

A get + person + to + V1

B get + thing + V3 ✓

C get + thing + V1

D get + person + V3

Why: The walls is a thing and painted is V3. This is the causative passive of GET.

Question 9 of 10

Spot the error. She was made sign the documents by the officer.

- A No error
- B *sign* should be *to sign*
- C *was* should be *were*
- D *by* should be *with*

Answer: Question 9

Spot the error: She was made sign the documents by the officer.

A No error

B *sign* should be *to sign* ✓

C was should be were

D by should be with

Why: MAKE in the passive needs TO before V1: was made TO SIGN the documents.

Question 10 of 10

Fill in the blank: He had his hair _____ at the new salon.

A cut

B to cut

C cutting

D cuts

Answer: Question 10

Fill in the blank: He had his hair _____ at the new salon.

A cut ✓

B to cut

C cutting

D cuts

Why: HAVE + thing + V3. The V3 form of cut is cut: had his hair cut.



Keep Practising. Keep Rising.

Remember the golden rule:
MAKE, LET and HELP bring TO in the passive.

HAVE and GET take 'the thing + V3.'